

your OS drive. The only limitation is that it works exclusively with Samsung SSDs, but within that ecosystem, it works reliably.

You also get multiple performance profiles. The drive runs in Standard mode by default, with options for Full Performance, Power Saving, and a custom profile. For most users, Standard mode is the sensible choice. Full Performance mode offers only minor gains while introducing some meaningful compromises, which I will get into later.

The only real downside here is the interface itself. Compared to older versions, Samsung Magician now feels a bit more cluttered. Sidebar ads and promotional elements make the experience feel less clean than it used to be. This isn't really a dealbreaker once you get used to it. The tool is quite polished otherwise.

PERFORMANCE AND BENCHMARKS

In synthetic benchmarks, the Samsung 9100 Pro 8 TB performed admirably, and the same was reflected in real-world usage as well when I used my system to edit some photos and videos, play games, multitask, and a lot more.

In Crystal Disk Mark, the Sequential read and write speeds were excellent, and the drive sits comfortably being one of the fastest consumer SSDs available in the market today. The IOPS and latency scores too, were well within what you would expect from a flagship PCIe Gen5 drive, especially under mixed and random workloads.

In PCMark 10, the drive scored 7,702 in the Full System Drive benchmark and 7,108 in the Quick System Drive test. These scores mean that in everyday usage, tasks like OS booting, file transfers, application launches, and game loading will be quick and hassle-free.



In day-to-day use, the Samsung 9100 Pro 8 TB feels effortlessly fast. Boot times are practically instant, applications open without hesitation, and working with large files feels smooth and predictable. Moving large video files, handling backups, or managing massive datasets is where this drive truly shows its strengths.

For gaming, the experience is once again excellent. Load times are short, but the difference compared to a premium Gen4 SSD like the 990 Pro is subtle. With that being said, it is important to note that if gaming is your primary use case, you will not see any major dramatic leaps just by moving to Gen5 storage drive.

THERMALS AND POWER CONSUMPTION

As expected from a PCIe Gen5 SSD, thermals need attention. With the integrated heatsink and motherboard cooling in place, temperatures stayed within safe limits, though controller temperatures can run high during extended workloads. Coming to power consumption, it is expectedly higher

than lower-capacity models. But that is the trade-off you make when running more NAND at higher speeds. This is clearly a desktop or workstation-class SSD rather than something meant for thermally constrained systems.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

The Samsung 9100 Pro 8 TB is not for everyone. It is expensive, and many high-end Gen4 SSDs cost far less while delivering excellent real-world performance. For casual users or gamers, those options make far more sense.

Where the 9100 Pro 8 TB earns its place is in capacity combined with speed. If you are a content creator working with high-resolution images

or 8K footage, a professional photographer dealing with massive image libraries, or a data-heavy user who wants everything on one ultra-fast drive, this SSD makes a strong case.

For everyone else, opting for a 4 TB variant or sticking with a premium Gen4 SSD will be the more cost-effective choice. In short, this is a focused, no-compromise storage solution built for users who know exactly why they need 8TB of PCIe Gen5 performance.

—Divyanshi Sharma

SPECIFICATIONS

Form Factor: M.2 (2280) | Interface: PCIe 5.0 x4, NVMe 2.0 | Dimensions: 80.15 x 25 x 11.25 mm | Weight: 35 g | Storage Memory: Samsung V-NAND TLC | Management Software: Samsung Magician | Endurance: 4,800 TB | Write speed: 13,400 MB/s | Read Speed: 14,800 MB/s | Cache: 8 GB LPDDR4 DRAM

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